

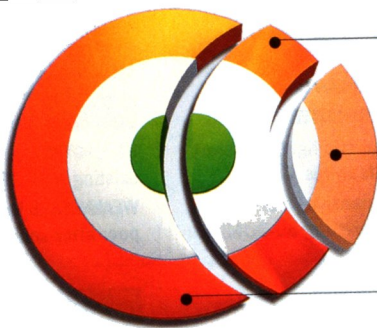
## THE FIGHT FOR FIGHTERS

IT WILL take three years for the deal to be inked and 10 years for the delivery of all aircraft.

AEROSPACE firms from US, France, UK, Russia and Sweden are in the reckoning. The winner will gain a strong foothold in Indian defence.

FOREIGN vendors have to reinvest half the value of the contract in India.

## WHY WE NEED THEM



**13**

Number of squadrons to be phased out in the next eight years.

**8**

Number of squadrons IAF has phased out since 2001.

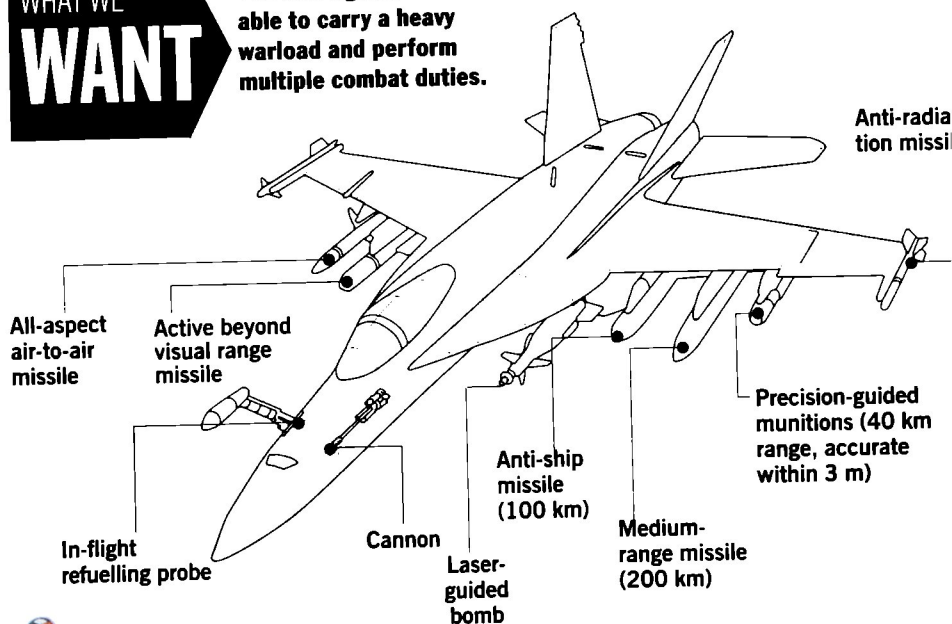
**26**

Number of squadrons IAF will be left with eight years hence.

IAF has a sanctioned strength of 39.5 squadrons of 18 combat aircraft each. It currently has 31 squadrons, its lowest in over 20 years. It will induct 350 new aircraft by 2015 but 600 old fighters are on their way out.

## WHAT WE WANT

The new fighter must be able to carry a heavy warload and perform multiple combat duties.



## IAF'S WISHLIST

- 40 twin-seat fighters, 86 single-seaters
- Fully-loaded weight of 14-30 tonne
- Service life of 6,000 flying hours/40 years
- Average utilisation rate of 150 hours of flying per aircraft per year
- Assured availability of at least 75 per cent for each aircraft

Graphic by RAM